

SLOVENIA

2016

Table of Contents

1. Overview of the tax-benefit system	2
2. Unemployment insurance	3
3. Unemployment assistance	10
4. Social assistance	11
5. Housing benefits for rented accommodation	18
6. Family benefits	21
7. Childcare for pre-school children	25
8. Employment-conditional benefits	28
9. Lone-parent benefits	30
10. Tax system	31
11. Part-time work	37
12. Policy developments	38
ANNEX DEFINITION OF SOCIAL SECURITY CONTRIBUTIONS AND PAYROLL TAXES	42

Introduction

Tax-benefit policy “country chapters” are made available as part of the OECD series *Benefits and Wages*. They provide detailed descriptions of tax and benefit rules in a consistent format across countries and summarize recent policy changes.

Country chapters for other countries and years are available on the Internet at www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

1. Overview of the tax-benefit system

1.1. *Average Worker wage (AW)*

The Slovenian currency is the euro (EUR). In 2016, EUR 0.90 was equal to USD 1. In that year, the average worker¹ in Slovenia earned EUR 18 292 (Secretariat estimate).

¹ AW refers to the Average Wage estimated by the Centre for Tax Policy and Administration (www.oecd.org/ctp). For more information on methodology see *Taxing Wages 2009-2010*, OECD, 2011, part IV.

2. Unemployment insurance

Statutory basis for unemployment insurance is “Labour Market Regulation Act” (*Zakon o urejanju trga dela - ZUTD*) (Official Journal (OJ) RS, no. 80/10, 21/13, 63/13, 100/13, 32/14-ZPDZC-1 and 47/15-ZZSDT) which began to be implemented on January 1st. 2011.

Program name in local language		Zavarovanje za primer brezposelnosti (Articles 54 – 70 of ZUTD)
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: minimum 9 months out of last 24 months (for persons younger than 30 yrs.: minimum 6 months out of last 24 months)
Waiting period (days)		0
Maximum duration (months)		12 25 for older than 55
Upgrading mechanism of the benefit		...
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	80%
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	60% from month 4 on 50% from month 13 on
	Calculation base	Gross
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	An insured person who seeks full-time employment and signs a part-time employment contract retains the right to be paid a proportionate part of the cash benefit for the difference to full-time employment.
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	age	0
	family situation	0
	contract type	0
	other	0

The article 60 of the *ZUTD* provides for persons older than 50 and 55 years longer maximum duration of unemployment benefit:

An unemployed person may claim the unemployment cash benefit lasting:

- two months for the insurance period ranging from six to nine months (only for unemployed persons younger than 30 yrs.)
- three months for the insurance period ranging from nine months to five years,
- six months for the insurance period ranging from 5-15 years,
- nine months for the insurance period ranging from 15-25 years,
- twelve months for the insurance period exceeding 25 years,

- nineteen months for insured persons older than 50 years of age and with the insurance period exceeding 25 years,
- twenty-five months for insured persons older than 55 years of age and with the insurance period exceeding 25 years.

Upon repeated enforcement of the right to cash benefit, the insurance period from which the right to cash benefit had been already assessed and the insurance period achieved based on receiving cash benefit shall not be included in the insurance period for cash benefit assessment. This provision does not apply to insured persons who upon repeated enforcement of the right are older than 57 years of age or have accumulated an insurance period of more than 35 years; for them the insurance period for cash benefit assessment includes whole insurance period of that person (Article 69 of the *ZUTD*).

2.1 *Conditions for receipt*

Payable for any registered unemployed person who is actively seeking full-time work. Conditions for receipt of unemployment benefits are:

- involuntary unemployment (i.e. through no fault of their own or against his/her own will),
- fulfillment of a minimum period of insurance,
- registration at the Employment Service of Slovenia (regional unit or branch office),
- application for benefit within 30 days of the termination of employment,
- capable of work,
- actively seeking employment and
- prepared to accept any appropriate or suitable employment offered by the Employment Service or other provider of employment brokerage services.

The aim of this Act is to assure security to insured persons if unemployment occurs through no fault of their own or against their will by providing an unemployment cash benefit in compliance with the reciprocity and solidarity principles. Rights to unemployment cash benefit shall not be exercised by an insured person who became unemployed through his/her own fault or volition.

It is necessary to become and remain entitled to the benefit that unemployed person is available for employment and he/she actively seeks employment.

Among other reasons, provided in Article 65 of the Act, the entitlement to cash benefit shall also cease within some reasons for the termination of record keeping in the register of unemployed persons and persons participating in active employment policy programmes; these reasons are: If an unemployed person refuses to enter an active employment policy programme or breaches an obligation arising from the contract on the entry in an active employment policy programme, refuses to accept appropriate or suitable employment or during a job interview does not endeavor to get the job, does not provide correct data regarding the eligibility for obtaining the status of the unemployed person or status of a participant in an active employment policy programme, if it is established by the competent authority that an insured person has been or is engaged in occasional or regular illegal employment, if an unemployed person is not an active job seeker, save exempted from this obligation by the employment plan or refuses to sign the employment plan in accordance with this Act Article 113 paragraph six (third, fourth, fifth, eighth, ninth and tenth indent of the first paragraph of Article 129 of the *ZUTD*).

2.1.1 *Employment conditions*

Unemployment Benefit qualifying period:

- Unemployment insurance rights may be obtained by an unemployed person who was insured for at least nine months in the last 24 months before the unemployment occurred (Article 59 of the ZUTD).
- insurance period ranging from six to nine months (only for unemployed persons younger than 30 yrs. – seventh paragraph of Article 60 of the ZUTD)
- Insurance rights shall be obtained by the insured person exclusively based on the contribution payments, if not otherwise determined hereunder for a specific event.

2.1.2 *Contribution conditions*

Insurance rights shall be obtained by the insured person exclusively based on the contribution payments, if not otherwise determined hereunder for a specific event.

Disregarding the previous paragraph, a person who was insured based on an employment relationship shall also obtain unemployment rights, even though the employer as the person liable for payment of unemployment insurance contributions failed to pay the latter and this irrespective of their recovery possibility. In these cases, the entire duration of the employment relationship shall be included in the insurance period of such insured person (second and third paragraph of Article 59 of the ZUTD).

Compulsory insurance for:

- persons who entered into an employment relationship with the Republic of Slovenia;
- persons who upon termination of their employment relationship receive wage compensation during temporary absence from work from the Health Insurance Institute of the Republic of Slovenia according to regulations governing health insurance;
- elected or nominated holders of a public or other office in the legislative, executive or judicial bodies in the Republic of Slovenia or in local self-government, if such persons receive salaries for their post;
- citizens of the Republic of Slovenia, employed in the Republic of Slovenia by foreign and international organizations and institutes, foreign diplomatic missions and consulates , if not otherwise specified by an international agreement and persons employed by foreign employers for which the laws of the Republic of Slovenia apply in compliance with EU regulations;
- self-employed persons;
- managers in a partnership, single-member private limited liability company and institutes;
- home care assistant, beneficiary of partial payment for lost income in line with the regulations governing social security;
- persons who based on the professional performance of foster placement have compulsory insurance in line with the law governing the pursuit of foster care, if not insured on some other basis;
- beneficiaries of parental compensation whose employment relationship has been terminated during parental leave according to the law governing parental protection and family benefits;
- parents who leave the labour market due to the childcare of four or more children for the period of eligibility for the payment of contributions according to the regulations governing parental protection;
- recipients of the unemployment cash benefit

(also see Article 54 of the ZUTD).

Voluntary insurance for:

- Slovenian citizens employed by an employer in a foreign country who upon returning to their homeland cannot exercise their unemployment rights on other grounds;

- spouses and unmarried partners of Slovenian citizens employed in a foreign country who were employed or self-employed immediately prior to their departure abroad;
- persons during the employment contract suspension according to the regulations governing employment relationships;
- spouses or unmarried partners of diplomats and other public servants assigned to work abroad if one year before their departure they had registered with the Employment Service as unemployed for at least six months;
- spouses or unmarried partners of diplomats and other public servants assigned to work abroad if one year before departure abroad they had been included in the unemployment insurance for at least six months, if such persons have no compulsory insurance hereunder (also see Article 57 of the ZUTD).

2.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

The cash benefit assessment basis shall be the average monthly salary received by an insured person eight months prior to the month of unemployment.

The cash benefit assessment basis for unemployed persons younger than 30 years shall be the average monthly salary received by an insured person five months prior to the month of unemployment.

If an insured person during the period referred to in the previous paragraph was a recipient of salary compensation pursuant to regulations governing employment relationships, health insurance, pension and disability insurance or parental protection insurance, the cash benefit assessment basis shall include the average salary received in the last eight months. If the insured person received salary for a shorter period, the received cash benefit shall be taken into account for the missing months.

The insured person who within the period referred to in the first paragraph of this Article worked for a shorter working time pursuant to regulations governing health insurance, pension and disability insurance or parental protection insurance, the cash benefit assessment basis shall include the received salary converted to full time work.

The cash benefit assessment basis for the insured person who did not receive salary or salary compensation in the aforementioned period shall include the received salary for the last eight months or, if the insured person only received salary for a shorter period, his/her basic salary for the missing months increased by the seniority allowance which the person would have received if he/she had worked.

The cash benefit assessment basis for the self-employed or persons who voluntarily entered compulsory insurance shall be the average basis from which contributions were paid for in the period referred to in the first paragraph of this Article or with voluntary insured persons for 11 months prior to the month the unemployment occurred (also see Article 61 of the ZUTD).

If the insured person was in the last nine months, more than half the time employed a part-time basis, which on average did not exceed 15 hours per week, or performed his work in this range on another legal basis, the amount of money should be levied in proportion to the duration of employment per month without taking into account the provisions of the second paragraph on the lowest monetary compensation (fourth paragraph of Article 62 of the ZUTD).

2.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

Unemployment benefits rates:

- first three months: 80% of the reference basis,

- following nine months: 60% of the reference basis.
- the assessment basis decreases after first 12 months of receiving cash benefit from 60 % **to 50 % of the basis.**

The minimum benefit amount is EUR 350. The highest benefit amount shall not exceed EUR 892.50 gross. In 2016 monthly gross statutory minimum wage was EUR 790.73.

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

Reasons for termination of the entitlement to benefits are defined by the law (11 reasons , also see Article 65 of the ZUTD), and related also to not being available for work, not searching work and unjustifiably declining employment, measures of training and education or other measures for reemployment, working illegally (moonlighting).

The insured person, who during cash benefit eligibility during unemployment performs work for which he/she receives or is eligible to receive income from work, which upon payment of taxes and mandatory contributions exceeds 200 Euros, is entitled to reduced cash benefit.

Income from work is construed as any income from any type of contractual relationship based on which the insured person performs physical or intellectual work, including the provision of services and creation or performance of copyrighted work. Income from work is also construed as income for performed work or services of a procurator (proxy) or for the management and supervision of a business entity with legal personality.

The cash benefit shall be reduced by 50% of the income from work which exceeds 200 Euros. If an insured person is raising minors, the cash benefit for each child shall be increased by 10% of the full amount of cash benefit to which the person concerned would have been entitled if the income from work was not generated, however it shall not exceed the full cash benefit amount. The reduction shall not be carried out if the cash benefit would have to be reduced by less than 20 Euros (also see Article 67 of the ZUTD).

The insured person who seeks full-time employment and signs a part-time employment contract shall retain the right to be paid a proportionate part of the cash benefit and proportionate part of contributions for pension and disability insurance until the fulfillment of conditions for retirement for the difference to full-time employment

(also see Article 66 of the ZUTD).

2.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Unemployment benefits are subject to personal income tax.

Changes of Labour Market regulation Act (ZUTD-B) was adopted in July 2013.

Amendments bring a shift in the activation of recipients of unemployment benefits. Long-term unemployed may be included in the Public Works (Active Labour Market Programme) for the duration of the right to unemployment benefit, taking half of the period in the Public Works considered as time to UB entitlement. This means that the long-term unemployed at this time instead of compensation receive a salary (that is, payment for work, expressed as a percentage of the minimum wage, as set out in Article 52 of the Act), while her right to unemployment benefit at the half time of inclusion in the program of public works will not be suspended. The new regulation also allows the transition from passive to active forms of assistance to long-term unemployed.

Furthermore, the law in favor of long-term unemployed also regulates example, if compensation was higher than the salary. In that case he or she is entitled to the difference between the salary and compensation.

2.4 *Benefit duration and waiting periods*

Unemployment benefit duration depends upon length of insurance:

- 2 months for the insurance period ranging from six to nine months (only for unemployed persons younger than 30 yrs.)
- 3 months for insurance of 1 to 5 years,
- 6 months for insurance of 5 to 15 years,
- 9 months for insurance of 15 to 25 years,
- 12 months for insurance of 25 years or more,
- 19 months for insured persons over 50 years of age with an insurance period of more than 25 years,
- 25 months for insured persons over 55 years of age with an insurance period of more than 25 years (see first and seventh paragraph of Article 60 of the ZUTD).

The right to cash benefit can be re-applied in case of obtaining new insurance period of at least 9 months (or at least 6 months for unemployed persons younger than 30 yrs.) in last 24 months (also see Article 59 and 60 of the ZUTD).

Upon repeated enforcement of the right to cash benefit, the insurance period from which the right to cash benefit had been already assessed and the insurance period achieved based on receiving cash benefit shall not be included in the insurance period for cash benefit assessment.

The provision of the previous paragraph shall not apply to insured persons who upon repeated enforcement of the right are older than 57 years of age or have accumulated an insurance period of more than 35 years (see Article 69 of the ZUTD).

2.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

2.5.1 *Young persons*

Benefit duration of two months for the insurance period ranging from six to nine months in last 24 months (only for unemployed persons younger than 30 yrs.)

2.5.2 *Older workers*

The duration of unemployment benefit is prolonged for unemployed persons aged 50 or more (see indent five and six of the first paragraph of Article 60 of the ZUTD).

Older unemployed persons are entitled to extended period of payment of pension and disability insurance contributions in the following cases: (*podaljšano plačevanje prispevka za pokojninsko in invalidsko zavarovanje za brezposelne osebe*):

- Insured unemployed citizens of the Republic of Slovenia, member state of the EU, EEA or Swiss Confederation or aliens with a permanent residence, whose entitlement to unemployment benefit has been exhausted and who lack less than one year insurance period for the fulfillment of

conditions for an old age retirement have the right to the payment of pension and disability insurance contributions from the state budget for the period up to one year.

- Insured unemployed persons aged at least 57 who completed at least 35 years of insurance period whose entitlement to unemployment benefit has been exhausted and who lack up to two years insurance period for the fulfillment of conditions for an old age retirement have the right to the payment of pension and disability insurance contributions from the state budget for the period up to two years (until 1 March 2018).
- For further information on the measure see transitional provision of the Article 38, paragraph 2, of the ZUTD-A.

2.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

The insured person who seeks full-time employment and signs a part-time employment contract shall retain the right to be paid a proportionate part of the cash benefit and proportionate part of contributions for pension and disability insurance until the fulfillment of conditions for retirement for the difference to full-time employment (also see Article 66 of the ZUTD).

3. Unemployment assistance

Labour Market Regulation Act does not foresee the right to unemployment assistance.

3.1 *Conditions for receipt*

3.1.1 *Employment conditions*

3.1.2 *Contribution conditions*

3.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

3.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

3.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

3.2.1.2 *Obligations of family members*

3.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

3.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

3.4 *Benefit duration and waiting periods*

Unemployed person could apply for benefits after the new period of employment – if he /she fulfill the conditions. When the right to cash benefit is reclaimed by an insured person whose right to this benefit terminated because it was entirely exercised the insurance period shall not include the period of employment prior to the last entitlement to cash benefit and the period in which the person concerned received the cash benefit. Notwithstanding the previous, the insurance period shall include the total duration of insurance, together with the period in which the person concerned received the cash benefit, when the right to cash benefit is reclaimed by an insured person older than 57 years or have accumulated an insurance period of more than 35 years.

3.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

3.5.1 *Young persons*

3.5.2 *Older workers*

3.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

4. Social assistance

Financial Social Assistance (*denarna socialna pomoč*) is a social benefit which acts as a final safety-net. It is provided to individuals and families who are unable to secure their material security, for reasons beyond their control. The purpose of Financial Social Assistance is to provide funds to meet the minimum needs at a level which allows the basic subsistence. There are two types of Financial Social Assistance: **Ordinary** and **Extraordinary** (described in section 4.2.1.1).

Supplementary Allowance (*varstveni dodatek*) is another social and financial benefit. Its purpose is to provide funds to cover living expenses that arise over a longer period and are not costs to meet the minimum needs.

Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance are administered locally and granted by Centres for Social Work (*Centri za socialno delo*).

Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance can be increased for the **Attendance Allowance** (*dodatek za pomoč in postržbo*) to persons incapable of work because of old age, disease or disability and in need of help of other persons to perform the basic vital functions. The need of help offered by other persons to perform the basic vital functions shall be established by the invalidity commission. The amount of attendance allowance depends on the established level of need.

Program name in local language		Denarna socialna pomoč
Minimum age condition for social assistance receipt		No
Legal behavioural requirements	Registration as unemployed	Yes
	Participation in integration measures	No
	Active job search	Yes
	Work requirement	No
	Other conditions for receipt of benefit (including requirements for conditional cash transfers (CCT))	No
	Legal behavioural requirements for adult family members other than the benefit claimant	Job search requirement
Determination of benefit levels		National
Uprating mechanism of the benefit		Adjusted in parallel with adjustments of the Minimum Income whose adjustment is regulated by the Act on adjustments of transfers to individuals and households in the Republic of Slovenia ((OJ) RS, 114/06)
Other supplements to basic benefit (per family)		No

Means-test for social assistance	Earnings disregards	No, but +28% of benefit if working 60 to 128 hours per month, +56% if more than 128 hours; +14% for other adult with 60 to 128 hours, +28% if more than 128 hours
	Benefit withdrawal rate with regard to earned income	100% with regard to net income
	Assets included in means test?	Yes
	Other benefits included in the means test	All, except home care benefit for parent staying at home
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	age	G: + higher rates for children in secondary education
	family situation	G: + 57% of basic rate for spouse, 66% to 76% per child, 20% for lone parent
	over time	0
	other	G: + higher rates if working

4.1 Conditions for receipt

Financial Social Assistance is paid conditionally on passing a means test. The eligibility for Financial Social Assistance is estimated each time case by case by the responsible Centre for Social Work. They are a one-stop-shop to which the applicant addresses the fulfilled application form for Financial Social Assistance for himself/herself and the family members, as well as other rights from public funds as defined in the Act on exercising the rights from public funds (*Zakon o uveljavljanju pravic iz javnih sredstev* (OJ) RS, 62/10 with changes). Granting of Financial Social Assistance (and other rights from public funds) at Centers Social Work is supported by IT application connecting different administrative data bases which are enabling the testing of means).

Beneficiaries are: all Slovenian citizens who have permanent residence in the Republic of Slovenia, foreigners who have permit for permanent residence in the Republic of Slovenia and permanent residence, persons granted international protection and their family members who have on the basis of the right to family reunification a residence permit in the Republic of Slovenia and have their permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Slovenia and those entitled on the basis of international agreements ratified by the Republic of Slovenia.

There is no age restriction for Financial Social Assistance, however for the Supplementary Allowance the beneficiaries are people above the age of 63 (women) and 65 (men) or with no age restriction in case of permanent incapacity for work or permanent unemployability. Supplementary Allowance is not granted to people who are in day-long institutional care.

Financial Social Assistance is granted to single persons or to families. The following family members are taken into account to determine the financial standing of the claimant: 1. claimant's spouse or partner equal to the spouse by family law or registrated same sex partner and claimant's children or stepchildren for the duration of his/her obligation of maintenance, or 2. claimant's parents for the duration of maintenance.

Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance are now regulated by the Social Protection Benefits Act (*Zakon o socialno varstvenih prejemkih* (OJ) RS, 61/10, with changes), that came into force on January 1st, 2012. The act stipulates that in order to become entitled to Financial Social Assistance, the individual without other means of subsistence that is capable of work must actively seek work (the person has to be registered at local employment office as unemployed and actively seek for a job) and met other conditions set in the above mentioned legislation.

Financial Social Assistance is not granted to persons who do not achieve the minimum income for reasons which they could or can influence or who, without valid reasons, reject, avoid or abandon activities which could or can lead to employment or to another method of improvement of their social situation or the social situation of their family members. The reason referred to this are for example termination of a job for specified reasons, failure to register with the body responsible for employment, unjustified rejection of an appropriate work under a contract for work or a copyright contract and to appropriate temporary or other similar work, unjustified abandonment of the exercise of a right which could influence the social situation of the person or his or her family members, unwillingness to accept the call for concluding the contract on means of support, refusal to conclude or failure to implement the contract on the active addressing of individual social problems, serving a prison sentence, loss of the means of subsistence or of any part of the income, notwithstanding its determination as own income or not according to this Act, for the reasons caused under the person's own influence.

The obligation of the beneficiary of the Financial Social Assistance is to accept any employment after receiving Financial Social Assistance for a certain time, i.e. 9 times in the last 12 months.

The Act on exercising the rights from public funds defines the order of rights to be claimed from public funds. The first right to be claimed is Child Allowance (in case the individual has children), and the second is Financial Social Assistance (followed by the Supplementary Allowance and State Scholarship). This means that in case of a family with children, the Child Allowance is granted first and the amount of it is calculated in the income of the family when means-testing for Financial Social Assistance is performed.

All incomes that are below the amount of Basic Minimum Income can be topped-up by financial social assistance (in case of eligibility).

4.2 Calculation of benefit amount

4.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

The level of Financial Social Assistance is linked to the Basic Minimum Income (*osnovni minimalni dohodek*) determined by and adjusted in accordance with the Social Protection Benefits Act. The amount of Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance is therefore adjusted in parallel with adjustments of the Basic Minimum Income. The Financial Social Assistance Act defined the Basic Minimum Income at the level of EUR 288.81. That was to be adjusted according to the Act regulating adjustments of transfers to individuals and households in the Republic of Slovenia ((OJ) RS, 114/06). However, before the implementation of the Financial Social Assistance Act started, the basic minimum income was lowered to EUR 260.00 by the Additional 2012 Intervention Measures Act ((OJ) RS, 110/11 - Zakon o dodatnih interventnih ukrepih za leto 2012) and later on by Fiscal Balance Act ((OJ) RS, 40/12 - Zakon za uravnoteženje javnih financ) that prolonged the basic minimum income amount of EUR 260.00 until the end of 2014. The amount of Basic Minimum Income from February the 1st 2013 on is EUR 261.65 (from January 2012 to February 2013 it was EUR 260.00). From August the 1st 2013 the amount increased to EUR 265.22. From January the 1st 2016 the Basic Minimum Income amount increased to EUR 288.81 (austerity measure introduced with the Fiscal Balance Act passed on 11 May 2012 was eliminated).

The amount of Financial Social Assistance depends on the income level, on the number of family members, on property and savings, on whether or not social services (housing, food etc.), are provided to the beneficiary and on whether there is misconduct on the part of the beneficiary (e. g. failure to register with the Employment Service, imprisonment). The amount is fixed by reference to the amount of the Basic Minimum Income (BMI).

The amount of the Financial Social Assistance is for a single person determined as a difference between the BMI for that person and the persons own income. For the family it is determined as a difference between the BMI for the whole family, i.e. by the sum of the amounts of minimum income for each family member and with the deduction of the families own income.

Families are entitled to Financial Social Assistance, if their total monthly income doesn't exceed the following thresholds:

- first adult, or a single person or an adult who is in institutional care: 100% of the BMI = EUR 288.81,
- first adult, or a single person who is economically active in the range of 60 to 128 hours per month: 128% of the BMI = EUR 369.67,
- first adult, or a single person who is economically active in a range of more than 128 hours per month: 156% of the BMI = EUR 450.54,
- a single person between the age of 18 and 26, registered with the Employment Service with a permanent residence at the same address as his/her parents or actually residing with them, providing that the parents have means for living: 70% of the BMI = EUR 202.16,
- a single person who is permanently unemployable or permanently incapable of work or who is older than 63 years (women) or 65 years (men) and who has his/her registered residence at the same address as a person who is not a family member as defined by this law and has his own sufficient means of subsistence or is actually residing with him/her: 76% of the BMI = EUR 219.50,
- every next adult person: 57% of the BMI = EUR 164.62,
- every next adult person economically active in a range of more than 128 hours per month: 85% of the BMI = EUR 245.48,
- every next adult person who is economically active in the range of 60 to 128 hours per month: 71% of the BMI = EUR 205.05,
- first, oldest child: 76% of the BMI = EUR 219.50,
- every next child: 66% of the BMI = EUR 190.61,
- increase for each child in a single-parent family if no subsistence benefits for child support are received: 20% of the BMI = EUR 57.76.

The monthly amount of Financial Social Assistance is therefore defined as the difference between corresponding thresholds and total income of an individual or family, according to the above mentioned rules.

The amount of Supplementary Allowance is calculated according to the BMI for each family member based on the same determining factors as Financial Social Assistance. The amount for a single person or first person in the family is fixed as 63% of the BMI (EUR 181.95). The amount for a single person who is permanently unemployable or permanently incapable of work or who is older than 63 years (women) or 65 years (men) and who has registered residence at the same address as a person who is not a family member as defined by this law and has his own sufficient means of subsistence or is actually residing with him/her is fixed as 69% of the BMI (EUR 199.28). For every other person in the family fulfilling the conditions the amount is 34% of the BMI (EUR 98.19).

The percentage for Supplementary Allowance is added to the percentage for Financial Social Assistance.

4.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

In cases where it is found that single persons or families, for reasons beyond their control, found themselves in a position of material threat, they can be granted - according to the needs - the Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance:

This type of Financial Social Assistance is granted in exceptional circumstances only, when a person finds him or herself in a situation of temporary material deprivation, caused by extraordinary living expenses which he or she cannot cover with his or her own income. It is more of a discretionary nature.

The monthly amount of Extraordinary Social Assistance cannot exceed the amount of Basic Minimum Income for a single person or a family, while the amount of one-off Extraordinary Assistance in one calendar year cannot exceed the amount of five Basic Minimum Incomes from which three can be granted only for extraordinary costs incurred due to natural disasters or force majeure.

Since January 1st 2014 there are also two new specific types of Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance, i.e. Special Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance after the Death of a Family Member (*posebna oblika izredne denarne socialne pomoči po smrti družinskega člana - posmrtnina*) and Special Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance for Covering Funeral Expenses (*posebna oblika izredne denarne socialne pomoči kot pomoč pri kritju stroškov pogreba - pogrebnina*). The purpose of these two types of extraordinary assistance is to provide financial assistance to relatives of the deceased and to partially cover funeral costs.

Special Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance after the Death of a Family Member and Special Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance for Covering Funeral Expenses is one-off payments payable to persons who are entitled to Financial Social Assistance in the event of death of their spouse, cohabitant, child, stepchild or parents and who are fulfilling the conditions set forth by law. The Special Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance after the Death of a Family Member equals 100% of the BMI (EUR 288.81 from January 1st 2016). The Special Emergency Financial Social Assistance for Covering Funeral Expenses equals 200% of the BMI (EUR 577.62 from January 1st 2016), however never more than the actual costs of the funeral.

4.2.1.2 *Obligations of family members*

Family members of the applicant, who because of inactivity do not meet the obligations regarding active job search (registration at employment office and actively seeking for a job or other reasons), are not entitled to Financial Social Assistance, so in calculating the amount of Basic Minimum Income they are not taken into account.

4.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

Total monthly income includes earnings, unemployment benefits and family benefits, minus income tax and social security contributions. "Income taken into account" also includes inheritance, gifts, income from agricultural and entrepreneurial activities and all wages and earnings of an individual or his family members which are subject to income tax, as well as non-taxable personal earnings.

All income and benefits are taken into account except:

- subsidies paid from the State budget for specific purposes,
- subsidies for young families as an incentive to address the housing question,
- one-off cash assistance under the legislation governing the protection against natural and other disasters,
- one-off solidarity assistance from the trade union to a member,
- compensation for damaged things that were available for defence needs or protection against natural disasters,
- income associated with agricultural and forestry activity,
- scholarships and other benefits paid to students,
- benefits for covering tuition fees, transport and housing,
- education or training fees and transport or lodging costs,
- transport to work and food allowance,
- cash assistance from humanitarian and disability organisations and charities up to the amount of the minimum income for the individual or family

From September 1st 2014, child allowance is taken into account without the addition of one-parent family, and without the addition of a child who is not enrolled in kindergarten, reduced by 20% the amount of child allowance for the first child of the first income bracket (EUR 22.86).

Since January 1st 2012 all real property (housing, land ...) and personal property (vehicles, different monetary funds ...) are also taken into account with some exceptions, such as for example housing where the beneficiary has a registered permanent residence and where he/she actually resides, personal vehicle of the value no higher than EUR 8,086.68 (since January 1st 2016), bank funds received by the person exclusively for the purchase or construction of housing (since January 1st 2014), cash worth up to three times the Basic Minimum Income for a single person, or, for a family up to three times the Basic Minimum Income within the limit EUR 2,500.00, for permanently unemployed, permanently incapable of work or older than 63 years (women) or 65 years (men) and are not employed, cash up to EUR 2,500.00 for a single person, or up to EUR 3,500.00 for a family with such a member (since January 1st 2014).

4.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance are not taxed.

4.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

The duration of Financial Social Assistance and/or Supplementary Allowance may not exceed a period of 3 months when granted for the first time

It can be prolonged for 6 months if circumstances remain unchanged. In special cases (women above 63 and men above 65 and other relevant circumstances) benefits may be granted for a maximum of 12 months. Permanent assistance is given to those whose social status is not likely to improve and who fulfil other specified conditions, such as age for women above 63 and men above 65 and are unemployed, or with no age limit in case of permanent incapacity for work or permanent unemployability and without property or who isn't in institutional care and his/hers family members also qualify under this above mentioned conditions (*from September 1st 2014*, who is in institutional care and his/hers family members also qualify under this above mentioned conditions).

Financial Social Assistance and/or Supplementary Allowance may be renewed if the circumstances serving as the basis for granting and determining the level of Financial Social Assistance during the period or the previous and renewed decisions remain unchanged.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

Financial Social Assistance and Supplementary Allowance must be returned with interest if obtained by giving false information or failing to report a change in circumstances. Recovery is mandatory. Within 60 days after the enforceability of the decision the recipient must return the unduly received social assistance benefits. Special arrangements on the method, time-frame, deferral or waiving of the recovery are possible.

Financial Social Assistance is not recuperated from the estate of a deceased beneficiary who has been receiving the assistance for 12 months or less, certain other benefits regarding the recuperation are also possible. Extraordinary Financial Social Assistance is not recuperated from the estate. Supplementary Allowance is recuperated only up to 2/3 of the received funds.

4.5 *Treatment of particular group*

Financial Social Assistance and/or Supplementary Allowance are given to single persons or to a family as a whole.

4.5.1 *Young persons*

Financial Social Assistance is also given to single persons aged over 18 years, who are registered as unemployed. If they are married or live with a partner or have children, than they are treated as a family.

4.5.2 *Older workers*

No special treatments.

4.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

In case of lone parents the amount of Financial Social Assistance for the family is increased for 20% of the Basic Minimum Income for each child in a single-parent family (since September 1st 2014). In 2016 20% of the BMI amounted to EUR 57.76..

5. Housing benefits for rented accommodation

Housing benefits are regulated by the Housing Act (*Uradni list RS*, št. [69/03](#), [18/04](#) – ZVKSES, [47/06](#) – ZEN, [45/08](#) – ZVEtL, [57/08](#), [62/10](#) – ZUPJS, [56/11](#) – odl. US, [87/11](#), [40/12](#) – ZUJF in [14/17](#) – odl. US). With the enforcement of the Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act (*OJ RS*, [62/10](#), [40/11](#), [40/12](#) – ZUJF, [57/12](#) – ZPCP-2D, [14/13](#), [56/13](#) – ZŠtip-1, [99/13](#), [14/15](#) – ZUUJFO, [57/15](#), [90/15](#), [38/16](#) – odl. US, [51/16](#) – odl. US in [88/16](#))), the responsibility for granting of housing benefit has been allocated to Social Work Centers, which have the authority to make decisions on all rights from public funds, including subsidies of non-profit and profit rents.

Regular housing benefits	Program name in local language		subvencija najemnine
	Entitlement depends on	Household type/size	Yes
		Income	Yes
		Dwelling size	Yes
		Geographic location	No
		Actual rental cost	Yes
	Description of regular housing benefit		Housing benefit is means-tested and covers part of rent for family whose income does not exceed certain threshold. The share of covered rent depends on the size of apartment and claimant's household income, and cannot exceed 80% of actual/estimated non-profit rent.
	Uprating mechanism of the benefit		...
Housing related support through other benefits		n.a.	

Analysis of paid subsidies:

Year	Paid subsidies (million EUR)	Number of claimants	Average monthly subsidy (in EUR)
2004	SIT 1,210M	6,900	SIT 14,614 (EUR 61)
2005	SIT 930M	5,400	SIT 14,352 (EUR 60)
2006	SIT 1,163M	5,700	SIT 17,025 (EUR 71)
2007	5.2M	5,870	74
2008	5.4M	5,340	84
2009	5.6M	5,450	86
2010	5.3M	5,411	82
2011	6.5M	6,067	89
2012	9.1M	7,668	104
2013	11.7M	9,014	109

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

2014	12.89M	11,634	115
2015	13.74M	12,556	113

Source: Ministry for environment and spatial planning (2004-2011),
Ministry of Labour, Family, Social Affairs and Equal Opportunities of the Republic of Slovenia (from 2012).

5.1 *Conditions for receipt*

Access to housing benefit is limited only to households renting and paying profit or non-profit rent with income under certain threshold. Income threshold is the sum of 1) minimum income of a household calculated according to the provisions regulating social assistance, 2) 30% of net household income and 3) estimated/actual non-profit rent. Income threshold varies according to the household composition taking into account the equivalence scale described under section 4.2.1.

Admission census/Income threshold:

Size of the Household	Income threshold (EUR) 2016
1 member	593
2 members (2 adults)	850
3 members (2 adults +1 child)	1.203
4 members (2 adults +2 children)	1.519

5.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

Amount of housing benefit depends on the claimant's income (household income) and ranges from 1% to 80% of the estimated/actual non-profit rent for apartment. Subsidy is calculated according to the size of apartment defined as appropriate for non-profit apartments taking into account the number of the household members.

Beneficiary must pay 20% of the rent and if beneficiary's ability of rent payment is below 20% then beneficiary is entitled for HB in amount of 80% of the rent. If beneficiary's ability is more than 20% of the rent then beneficiary is entitled for HB in amount of difference between the ability and rent.

Beneficiary's ability is calculated as the amount over and above the difference of Net Income (minus 30%) and Basic Minimum Income (BMI described in section 4.2.1).

5.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

The following maximum amounts are payable.

Size of the Household	Upper limit of HB per month (in EUR)
1 member	85
2 members	125
3 members	152

4 members	180
5 members	208
6 members	235

5.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

5.2.3 *Costs eligible for housing benefits*

In the valid housing legislation and its implementing regulations, maximum or acceptable housing costs are not determined, neither as the average nor by types of households. Therefore, the level of allowable or desired costs related to the use of housing in a region or municipality are not monitored or determined in any other way.

5.3 ***Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits***

Housing benefits are not taxed.

5.4 ***Treatment of particular groups***

5.4.1 *Young persons*

5.4.2 *Older workers*

5.4.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

Standards for the size of non-profit apartment and for housing benefit claimant:

- 1 person: 20-30m²
- 2 persons: 30-45 m²
- 3 persons: 45-55 m²
- 4 persons: 55-65 m²
- 5 persons: 65-75 m²
- 6 persons: 75-85 m²
- for further member +6m²

6. Family benefits

Program name (local name in parentheses if available)			Family benefit (družinski prejemek)	Large family allowance (dodatek za veliko družino)	Increase of child benefit in case of lone parent family
Type of benefit			Targeted	Targeted benefit for families with 3 or more children	Targeted
Eligibility criteria	Age limits for children up to and including (in parentheses if student)		17 (25)	17 (25)	17 (25)
	Other conditions for receipt of benefit (including requirements for conditional cash transfers (CCT))		No	No	No
Up rating mechanism of the benefit			...	...	...
Benefit amount	Benefit amount per child varies with (where +/- denotes increase/decrease: +++/--- above proportional, +/- - proportional, +/- below proportional, +/- variable, 0: no effect)	Age of child	+	0	0
		Number of children	++	+ for fourth child, 0 from thereon	++ (30% increase of regular benefit)
	Earnings disregard		Benefit calculated based on six brackets of net earnings, fully withdrawn if over EUR 638.09 per month (same across all three programmes)		
	Withdrawal rate		100%	100%	100% with regard to regular benefit
	Assets part of means test?		...	...	...

6.1 Conditions for receipt

The claimant (one of the parent or another person for a child) must have a dependent child aged under 18, or under 26 if is still in education or the child is over 18 and has no parents or does not live in a joint household with parents, if the Centre of social work decides so on the basis of the circumstances.

6.2 Calculation of benefit amount

The aim of child benefit is to provide parents or the child supplementary income for living, raising and education when the income per family members does not exceed the maximum limit of income bracket. All included amounts are net income.

6.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit**Child benefit amounts in 2016 to (in EUR per month):**

Number of income bracket	Income per family member in % of the average monthly wages of all employee and in EUR	Amount of child benefit for each child (child younger than 18)			Amount of child benefit for a child included in the secondary school (child younger than 18)		
		1st child	2nd child	3rd and subsequent child(ren)	1st child	2nd child	3rd and subsequent child(ren)
1	Up to 18 %, thus EUR 182.38	114.31	125.73	137.18	114.31	125.73	137.18
2	over 18 % to 30 %, thus EUR 182.38 to EUR 303.97	97.73	108.04	118.28	97.73	108.04	118.28
3	over 30 % to 36 %, thus EUR 303.97 to EUR 364.76	74.48	83.25	91.98	74.48	83.25	91.98
4	over 36 % to 42 %, thus EUR 364.76 to EUR 425.56	58.75	67.03	75.47	58.75	67.03	75.47
5	over 42 % to 53 %, thus EUR 425.56 to EUR 537.01	48.04	56.06	64.03	48.04	56.06	64.03
6a	over 53 % to 56%, thus EUR 537.01 to EUR 567.4	30.44	38.10	45.71	30.44	38.10	45.71
6b	over 56 % to 64%, thus EUR 567,4 to EUR 648.47	30.44	38.10	45.71	43.44	51.10	71.17

If a pre-school child does not attend kindergarten in accordance with the regulations for kindergartens, the amount of the child benefit is increased by 20%.

This 20% increase is paid for the child of kindergarten age. The increase is based on a fact that the state and local communities are not able to ensure access to the kindergartens due to the lack of capacities. Therefore, those families whose children are not included in kindergartens are entitled to the supplement for care.

In addition to child benefit there are following supplementary allowances available:

- **Child birth allowance:** one-time assistance at childbirth (financial assistance - amount EUR **280.00** in 2016)

Property census for the right to child birth allowance was defined regarding the division of classes established to determine the right to child benefit. The census for the right to child birth allowance thus equalised to the 6th class of the said division for the right to child benefit, which presents 64% of average monthly income per family member e.g. EUR 648.47 per family member. The right can be claimed either mother or by father of the child.

- **Parental allowance** - financial assistance (365 days after the birth of a child or longer in case of special circumstances: birth of twins or triplets, premature birth...) to parents when they are not entitled to parental compensation after the birth of the child. In the year 2016 parental allowance amount to EUR **252.04** per month.
- **Large family allowance** is an annual benefit for families with three or more children. In 2016 large family allowance for three children amount to EUR **395.00**, for four or more children amount to EUR **480.00** and is paid as a lump sum payment.

Property census for the right to large family allowance was defined regarding the division of classes established to determine the right to child benefit. The census for the right to large family allowance thus equalised to the 6th class of the said division for the right to child benefit, which presents 64% of average monthly income per family member e.g. EUR 648.47 per family member.

- **Partial payment for lost income.** Partial payment for lost income is a personal benefit to one of the parents who has terminated his or her employment or started to work short time in order to care and safeguard a child with severe disturbance in mental development or severe disability in movement. The monthly amount of partial payment for lost income is EUR 734.15 for which the person concerned pays social security contributions.

6.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

6.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

Child benefit is defined as percentage from the average monthly wage of all employees in the Republic of Slovenia (from statistical survey Monthly Report on Earnings by Legal Persons) for the calendar year before the application is filed and is tested once a year. The amount of the child benefit also depends on the number of children in the family receiving child benefit.

6.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Child **benefits** are not taxed.

Child birth allowance is not taxed.

Parental allowance is not taxed.

Large family allowance is not taxed.

Partial payment for lost income is taxed.

6.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

6.4.1 *Young persons*

6.4.2 *Older workers*

6.4.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

Lone parents: The amount of child benefit is increased by 30% (only for child benefit (6.2.1 page 10))

Special Child Care Allowance for a Child in Need of Special Care: Additional allowance. The monthly amount of special care allowance is in 2016 EUR **100.00**. For a child with severe disturbances in mental development and children with severe disability in movement, who need special care, the allowance is EUR **200.00**.

The Special Child Care Allowance for a Child in Need of Special Care is not taxed.

7. Childcare for pre-school children

Pre-school education, offered by pre-school institutions, is not compulsory. The curriculum is divided in two cycles (from 1 to 3 and from 3 to 6). The new curriculum promotes different types of programme such as: day, half-day and short programmes. There is also possibility of child minders, pre-school education at home or occasional care of children in their homes. The Curriculum for Pre-school Institutions was approved by Council of Experts and it defines six areas of activities: movement, language, art, nature, society and mathematics. The goals set in individual fields of activities provide the framework for selection of contents and activities by teachers.

Enrolment rates for pre-school education for school year 2015/16²:

From 1-3 years: 57.6%

From 3-5 years: 88.6%

Total: 76.6%

Compulsory schooling starts at the age of 6 (children whose sixth birthday occurs in the calendar year of their school entry are enrolled).

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

Childcare fees are not tax deductible.

The system of determining parents' payments for kindergarten programs is determined by the Kindergarten Act and the Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act (*Zakon o uveljavljanju pravic iz javnih sredstev ZUPJS*). This regulates all the individual social rights, providing basis also for the calculation of the kindergarten fees to be paid by parents.

The price of the program for which parents pay a certain percentage is determined by the municipality on the proposal of the kindergarten. The kindergarten calculates the price on the basis of identified costs of education, care and food in the kindergarten.

Kindergartens conduct all-day programs (lasting from 6 to 9 hours), half-day programs (lasting from 4 to 6 hours) and shorter programs (lasting from 240 to 720 hours). Most of the children (97%) are included in all-day programs.

From 1 September 2008 till the 1 June 2012 the government was providing funds for co-financing the payment of parents with more than one child from the same family enrolled in the kindergarten at the same time. The amount provided by the government was determined by a decision as parents' payment for the kindergarten program in which the younger children were included. In this case parents were paying only for the oldest child in the kindergarten, while for the others they were exempt from payment, and the fee for the oldest child was one bracket lower than normally.

In 2012, these benefits had to be reduced due to a high deficit in public finances. *The Fiscal Balance Act (Zakon o uravnoteženju javnih financ)*, passed on the 11th of May and applicable in the area of exercising

² Source: Statistical Office of the Republic of Slovenia

different rights from public funds from June 1st this year, affected also financial incentives for families with more than one child in kindergarten. The Act stipulates: that the percentage of the childcare fee to be paid by parents for the oldest child has to be determined by a decision; that the fee for the second child enrolled in the kindergarten at the same time will amount to 30% of the fee paid by parents for the oldest child; and that for all younger children they remain exempt of paying the kindergarten fees.

The Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act (*ZUPJS*) applies to all the individual social rights (incomes, subventions, payments), Decisions relating to the exercise of these rights are made by the centers for social work in accordance with the common procedure and method of assessing parents' status (income, property) based on official data. Payments of parents are calculated following the grid set by the given Act, which - taking into account the level of income per person in comparison with the net average salary in Slovenia - defines 9 grades. The 1st grade comprises parents with lowest income, to be exempt of kindergarten fees payment; the 9th comprises those whose average monthly income per person amounts to 99% of the net average salary and who would pay 77% of the kindergarten program fee.

Income brackets according to the average net earnings in 2014 (EUR 1,005.41) used to determine parents' payments as of **1 January 2015**³

Income bracket	Average net monthly income per family member in % compared to average earnings in Slovenia in the previous calendar year	Payment (% of the program price)
1.	Under 18%	0%
2.	Over 18% to 30%	10%
3.	Over 30% to 36%	20%
4.	Over 36% to 42%	30%
5.	Over 42% to 53%	35%
6.	Over 53% to 64%	43%
7.	Over 64% to 82%	53%
8.	Over 82% to 99%	66%
9.	Over 99%	77%

The Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act (*ZUPJS*) keeps a possibility for the municipalities to further reduce kindergarten fees to be paid by parents, according to their social policies.

The Ministry of Education, Science and Sport collects data on the prices of kindergartens and parents' payments. In 2016, the average price for the 1st age group (for children between one and three years of age) was EUR 449.15 and for the 2nd age group (children from three years of age to the age of entering basic compulsory school) EUR 339.33.⁴ The average of both is EUR 394.24.

³ Source: Ministry of Labour, Family, Social Affairs and Equal Opportunities

⁴ Source: Ministry of Education, Science and Sport

7.2 Child-care benefits

7.2.1 Conditions for receipt

Conditions for receipt

The right to child benefit shall be granted to one of the parents or another person for a child younger than age of 18, who legally resides in the Republic of Slovenia and actually lives in the Republic of Slovenia when the income per family member does not exceed the maximum limit of income class pursuant to Parental Protection and Family Benefits Act.

The right to child benefit shall not be granted to one of the parents for the child who in order to obtain education, schooling or training lives in an institution which provides fulltime care free of charge.

7.2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

7.2.2.1 Calculation of benefit

The income is calculated in such way that the total income and assets of persons is divided with the number of persons and the number 12.

7.2.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

The limits of income for establishing the eligibility to the rights to public funds are determined regarding the average monthly salary after the payment of taxes and compulsory contributions for social security per employee in the Republic of Slovenia according to the data of the Statistical Office of the Republic of Slovenia in the calendar year prior to the year when the application is submitted (hereinafter: net average salary), except if the Act stipulates otherwise. If the net average salary for the previous calendar year is still not available, then the net average salary for the year before the previous year is considered.

7.2.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

Child care benefits are not taxed.

7.2.4 Treatment of particular groups, including disabled

The amount of the child benefit shall be laid down on the basis of family placement in the income bracket and the number of the children. The child benefit for the child who lives in a single-parent family shall be increased by 30%.

8. Employment-conditional benefits

1. Employment rehabilitation.

Persons with disability are eligible for employment rehabilitation programme including services for persons with disability for counseling, motivating and empowering persons with disability for taking active part in their employment lives, making assessment on working abilities, knowledge, skills and professional interests, psychosocial rehabilitation and informing of options in labour market, follow-up of social and working environment, helping to find proper job, helping for developing professional goals and social skills, analysis of working environment, analysis of required technology in working environment, training for specific job.

Eligibility depends on:

- Whether there is influence of the effects of physical or mental disability or disease on an individual.
- Needs for services of employment rehabilitation as a part of whole rehabilitation.
- Level of employability by adapting working environment or using of modern technology.
- Assessment of social or working environment.

2. Allowance

Persons with disability who participate in programme of employment rehabilitation are eligible for temporary allowance to compensate loss of income for the time of participation. Allowance also includes travel and accommodation expenses of the participants.

Employment service of Slovenia has the authority to decide about the entitlement of the status or rights of persons with disability.

3. Subsidy of salary

Persons with disability are eligible for compensation of lower incomes due to their lack of productivity.

The subsidy is intended for employees with disability in protected and supported work places. 30-70% of salary is intended for those employed in protected work places, 5-30% of salary for those in supported employment and 5-30% of salary for those employed in companies for persons with disability. Subsidy is dependent on level of disability.

The entitlement for subsidy is decided upon Foundation for promoting employment of persons with disability.

8.1 *Conditions for receipt*

8.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

8.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

8.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Subsidies are taxed in the hands of the employers.

There are tax allowances for the employers (the deduction of the tax base equals to 50% of the salary of the disabled person; or 70% in the cases of the special disability defined by the law.

For the taxpayer that does not employ workers and that is acknowledged as disabled may claim a deduction of the tax base equals to 30 % of the average monthly wages of employees in Slovenia; or 60 % in the cases of the special disability defined by the law.

8.4 *Benefit duration*

Benefit duration is dependent on duration of the participating in Programme of employment rehabilitation, whilst subsidy is not limited.

8.5 *Treatment of particular group*

8.5.1 *Young persons*

8.5.2 *Older workers*

8.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

9. Lone-parent benefits

(See chapter 6 on Family benefits)

9.1 Conditions for receipt

9.2 Calculation of benefit amount

9.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

9.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

9.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

9.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

9.4 Benefit duration

9.5 Treatment of particular group

9.5.1 Young persons

9.5.2 Older workers

9.5.3 Others if applicable, including disabled

10. Tax system

Income from employment which includes income of part-time workers and unemployment benefits is taxed in a way that the taxable bases of different sources of income earned in a calendar year are computed separately and then aggregated. In computing the taxable base the contributions for social insurance and standard and nonstandard, if any, allowances are deducted. The net tax base is taxed at progressive rates. The annual tax rate schedule is fixed and is only adjusted on a yearly basis if the coefficient of the growth of the consumer price in Slovenia for August of the current year compared to the August of the preceding year, according to data from the Statistical Office of the Republic of Slovenia, exceeds 1.03.

Financial social assistance, housing benefit or child benefits are not taxed.

Self-employed individual has an income in a form of profit and is included in the social insurance systems (pension and disability, health, unemployment and maternity leave).

10.1 Income tax

Personal income tax is levied on six categories of income: income from employment, business, basic agriculture and forestry, rental and royalties, capital (interest, dividends and capital gains) and other income. Income tax, thus except income from capital, rental income and income deriving from business for which the tax base is determined using lump sum deductions, is taxed aggregated at yearly level and at progressive rates (16 %, 27 %, 41 % and 50 %) and taking into account the allowances and deductions. So-called capital income (interest, dividends and capital gains) and also income from rental are taxed at proportionate rates (25 %) on a scheduled basis. Under certain conditions personal business income may be taxed on a scheduler basis using a lump-sum deduction regime (the tax base is determined on the basis of lump-sum costs accounting for 80 % of income). The tax rate is 20 %. The tax is treated as a final tax for residents and non-residents alike.

10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits

10.1.1.1 Standard allowances

Allowances that reduce the aggregated taxable base for a resident taxpayer on an annual level include:

1. General allowance: EUR 3,302.70 in 2016 for all resident taxpayers.
 - additional general allowance for residents with lower income:
 - EUR 3,217.12 for resident taxpayers with active income up to EUR 10,866.37 (together EUR 6,519.82);
 - EUR 1,115.94 for resident taxpayers with active income more than EUR 10,866.37 and up to EUR 12,570.89 (together EUR 4,418.64).
2. Family allowances are granted to residents who support their family members. The allowances for 2016 are as follows:
 - EUR 2,436.92 for the first dependent child;
 - EUR 2,649.24 for the second child;
 - EUR 4,418.54 for the third child;
 - EUR 6,187.85 for the fourth child;
 - EUR 7,957.14 for the fifth child;
 - EUR 1,769.30 for the sixth and all additional maintained children relative to the level of relief for the preceding maintained child;

- EUR 8,830.00 for a dependent child who requires special care;
- EUR 2,436.92 for any other dependent family member.

Family allowance for a dependent child can be granted only to one taxpayer (parent), the other can use only a difference to the granted allowance.

Under the Personal Income Tax Act a dependent family member is a spouse who is not employed and performs no business activities, has no income of her/his own for maintenance or she/he has an income which is less than the level of special relief for a maintained family member (EUR 2,436.92 in year 2016) and the separated or divorced spouse of the taxpayer, if such spouse has been granted the right to maintenance paid by the taxpayer under a court order or agreement concluded pursuant to the regulations on marital union and family relations.

3. Special deduction for voluntary supplementary pension insurance: amounts of premium paid by a taxpayer or his employer but no more than 24% of compulsory contributions for pension and disability insurance paid by a taxpayer but no more than EUR 2,819.09 annually (for 2016).

4. Non-standard tax reliefs applicable to income from employment:

- travelling to the work (up to the costs of public transport),
- meal during the work (up to EUR 6.12 per day),
- daily allowance for expenses during business travel (limited),
- expenses for business travel (documented),
- expenses for hotel during business travel (documented),
- compensation for the use of an employee's own possessions and property when working at home,
- compensation for the use of an employee's own tools and other equipment (except private vehicles),
- compensation for a separate residence (up to EUR 334 per month);
- a long-service bonus jubilee award for the total work period or for the total work period with the last employer (different according to the years of service), retirement bonus and one-off solidarity assistance up to the amount determined by the Government of the Republic of Slovenia.

10.1.1.2 Standard tax credits

There is no standard tax credit.

10.1.2 Income tax schedule (central government income tax)

Tax schedule for the year 2016 is:

Taxable base (EUR)	Rate
up to 8,021.34	16%
8,021.34 to 20,400.00	EUR 1,238.41 + 27% over EUR 8,021.34
20,400.00 to 70,907.20	EUR 4,625.65 + 41% over EUR 20,400.00
above 70,907.20	EUR 25,333.60 + 50% over EUR 70,907.20

10.1.3 State and local income taxes

There is no personal income tax on the local level.

10.2 Treatment of family income

Personal income tax applies to an individual's income. Each individual is treated as a separate taxpayer. There is no taxation of spouses or a family as a whole.

The taxpayer is entitled to the family allowance for a dependent child and other dependent family member—for example a spouse without income of her/his own.

Family allowance for a dependent child is transferable between partners/spouses. The allowance for the same maintained family member in the tax year shall be granted only to one taxpayer, while another may be granted only the possible difference up to the total amount of the relief.

10.3 Social security contributions and payroll taxes

There are four compulsory social security insurance schemes:

- i) pension and disability insurance;
- ii) health insurance;
- iii) unemployment insurance and
- iv) maternity leave insurance.

Persons liable to pay contributions are insured individuals (employees, self-employed persons, including farmers, other individuals), employers and other persons.

In general both employers and employees pay compulsory social security contributions.

The basis for social security contributions of employees and employers is the amount of the gross wages and salaries (with no limitations), including other income from employment (such as vacation payments, fringe benefits and remuneration of expenses related to work above a certain threshold).

The system of health insurance is divided into compulsory health insurance, voluntary health insurance for additional coverage, and insurance for services that are not a constituent part of compulsory insurance.

The pension and disability insurance system covers:

- compulsory pension and disability insurance based on the intergenerational solidarity;
- compulsory supplementary pension insurance (occupational pension insurance);
- voluntary supplementary pension insurance on the basis of personal pension savings accounts.

Compulsory social security contributions are not taxed.

10.3.1 Contributions payable by employees and benefit recipients

Pension insurance	15.50%
Health insurance	6.36%
Unemployment insurance	0.14%
Maternity leave	0.10%
Total	22.10%

Employees' contributions are deductible for personal income tax purposes.

10.3.2 Contributions payable by employers

Pension insurance	8.85%
Health insurance (including insurance against injuries at work and occupational diseases)	7.09%
Unemployment insurance	0.06%
Maternity leave	0.10%
Total	16.10%

Employers' contributions are deductible for corporate income tax purposes.

10.3.3 Payroll taxes

There is no payroll tax.

10.4 Treatment of particular group

10.4.1 Young persons

Resident students are granted special allowance of EUR 2,477.03 for income earned by pupils or students for temporary work done on the basis of a referral issued by a special organization dealing with job-matching services for pupils and students.

School meals are determined by two Acts: the School Meals Act, which regulates the organisation of school meals for students in compulsory basic (single structure of primary and lower-secondary education called basic school) and upper secondary education, and the Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act. The price for snack in basic school and a meal in upper-secondary school is determined by the Minister and schools must provide a meal within such a determined price. Students of socio-economically disadvantaged backgrounds are entitled to a subsidy for school meals.

Compulsory basic school:

- students whose income per family member amounts to 53% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to the total price of one light school meal (snack) per day;

In addition to this:

- students whose income per family member amounts to 18% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to the total price of one school lunch per day;
- students whose income per family member amounts from over 18% and 30% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to a subsidy of 70% of the price for one school lunch per day;
- students whose income per family member amounts from over 30% and 36% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to a subsidy of 40% of the price for one school lunch per day.

Upper secondary school:

- students whose income per family member amounts to 42% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to the total price of one school meal* per day.

- students whose income per family member amounts from over 42% and 53% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to a subsidy of 70% of the price for one meal* per day;
- students whose income per family member amounts from over 53% and 64% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to a subsidy of 40% of the price for one meal* per day.

- Upper secondary schools are obliged to organise for their students a warm meal or a nutritious and energy-rich cold meal.

Every pupil enrolled in basic school education (single structure of primary and lower secondary compulsory education) can participate in at least one open-air school event. All are entitled to receive financial support for this at least once during their schooling. For children involved in programs for children with special needs and in special programs of education and training, these funds are provided for more than one generation of pupils. There are special subsidies to support the participation of pupils of socio-economically disadvantaged backgrounds.

The Ministry of Education, Science and Sport provides free textbooks from textbook funds for all children enrolled in basic school (single structure of primary and lower-secondary compulsory education). Textbook funds in basic schools are obligatory, while upper-secondary schools are free to set up textbook funds. Yet, most of them decide to do, with possible financial support from the state budget and a certain participation fee by the students. This however, must not exceed one third of the price at which the textbook was purchased by the school. There are special subsidies for socially disadvantaged students, allowing them to borrow textbooks for free.

Local communities by law provide free transportation for children whose residence is located more than four kilometers from the basic school. First-grade children have the right to free transport irrespective of the distance from their residence to their school, while in the other grades they have this right if the competent road traffic safety authority finds that the safety of children on the way to school is endangered.

Children and pupils with special needs have the right to free transport, irrespective of the distance from their residence to their school if so determined by the decision on the assignment. Students who need education in specialized institutions have the right to free care and free transport home during school days off.

Funds for the transport of basic school children and funds for the protection of commuters who are threatened by dangerous wild animals on their way to school are provided from the national budget.

Funds to subsidize transport are provided from the national budget for pupils and students who have their place of residence at least 2 km from the place of education and the status of:

- Pupil;
- Participant in adult education enrolled in an accredited study programme of upper-secondary, vocational and higher professional education, if they are not employed or registered as unemployed or are not participating the education process in accordance with the regulations on the organization of the labor market until the age of 26;
- Student if they are not employed.

Living in a residence hall for upper secondary school students: In case a family has two or more children who reside in a residence hall for upper secondary school students, parents pay only for the first child and no fee for others.

The Republic of Slovenia subsidizes accommodation of students in public and private residence hall, with other private operators registered for the service of student accommodation and through the latter with the private operator's owners of rooms.

Subsidizing student accommodation to the citizens of the Republic of Slovenia is based on several criteria, such as learning outcomes i.e. study success, economic background, distance between the permanent place of residence and the place of study, social and health situation of students.

10.4.2 *Older workers*

There is no special tax allowance for the older workers according to personal income tax.

10.4.3 *Others if applicable*

Personal allowances for income tax purposes:

- Disabled person's allowance: EUR 17,658.84 in 2016

Tax credits for income tax purposes:

- equal to 13.5% of the pension received from compulsory pension and disability social insurance.
- equal to 13.5% of the compensation received from compulsory disability social insurance as disabled worker.

Self-employed individuals are obliged to pay social security contributions (SSC) on the basis of their profits. They are obliged to pay SSC on the monthly basis. There is no consolidation on a yearly level.

The self-employed are obliged to pay social security contributions on the basis of their profits made in previous year reduced by 25 %.

But there is a major difference in determining the minimum insurance base for pension insurance and minimum insurance base for health insurance. That is if the self – employed person creates a loss or a profit (reduced by 25 % for the year 2016) that is less than the 56 % of average wage (AW) then it is the minimum insurance base equal to the 56 % of the AW but only for pension, unemployment insurance and maternity leave (with contribution rate 24.75 %). If self-employed person creates a loss or a profit (reduced by 25 %) that is less than the 60 % of the AW, the base for the social security contributions for health insurance (with rate 13.45 %) is equal to the 60 % of the AW.

The maximum insurance (contribution) base is defined as the amount of 350% of the AW. Self-employed individuals can opt to pay their SSC at a higher insurance (contribution) base than the one calculated on the basis of their profit but no higher than the amount equal to 350% of the AW.

Contributions payable by **Self-employed**

Pension insurance	24.35%
Health insurance (including insurance against injuries at work and occupational diseases)	13.45%
Unemployment insurance	0.20%
Maternity leave	0.20%
Total	38.20%

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

11. Part-time work

11.1 *Special benefit rules for part-time work*

11.2 *Special tax and social security contribution rules for part-time work*

There is no special tax regime for a part-time work.

12. Policy developments

12.1 Policy changes introduced from 1 July 2015 – 1 July 2016

Ministry of Finance:

With amendment to Fiscal Balance Act (ZUJF) Slovenia increased net annual tax bracket between the 2nd and 3rd tax class above which income tax is paid at the rate of 41% from EUR 18,960 to EUR 20,400; while it extended the validity of the fourth tax class with the rate of 50% for incomes above EUR 70,907. The latter measure is in place from January 1st 2016 till December 31th 2017.

The following measures with the aim to reduce administrative barriers and increase the efficiency of the collection of public levies thus making opportunities to improve the competitiveness of the business environment were introduced:

- *some improvements of the existing tax legislation* – by (a) removing administrative burdens and (b) simplifying the tax collection process and the fulfillment of tax obligations for taxable persons with general overview of the Tax Procedure Act and particular procedures of collecting taxes and social security contributions;
- *simplification of charging VAT on the import of goods* for taxable persons identified for VAT purposes in Slovenia – the importers will no longer be required to pay the VAT on the importation of goods, but will instead make the payment of VAT through a VAT return for the tax period in which the goods were imported;
- *the introduction of certified cash registers* with the on-line transmission of data to the Financial Administration; by the Act on fiscal verification of invoices which came into force on August 1st 2015 cash registries are enacted in the form of a procedure of fiscal verification of invoices, starting from January 2nd 2016.

Higher VAT rates (22% and 9.5%) introduced in 2013 remain unchanged.

Ministry of Labour, Family, Social Affairs and Equal Opportunities:

In November 2015, the **Act on Emergency Measure in the field of Labour Market** (OJ RS, No. 90/2015) was adopted. The Act introduces temporary subsidy with an exemption from the obligation of payment of employer's contributions for older unemployed persons with the aim to improve their employability until end of 2017. The main goal of the measure is to stimulate employers to employ older unemployed persons on the permanent or temporary basis. Employer, who concludes a permanent or temporary contract with a person of more than 55 years old, being registered at PES for at least six months, is exempted from paying employer's social contribution for the first 24 months of employment. The measure is in place from 1 January 2016 till 31 December 2017.

In November 2015 the amendments to **the Exercise of Rights from Public Funds Act** were adopted by which child benefits for the fifth and the sixth income brackets have been increased as described under the Chapter 6. 2. 1.

In November 2015, **the Act amending the Social Protection Benefits Act** (*Zakon o spremembah Zakona socialno varstvenih prejemkih*) (OJ RS, 90/15) was adopted. The Act entered into force in November 2015 and has been implemented since January 2016. The Act amending the Social Protection Benefits Act sets the BMI at EUR 288.81. The thresholds for receiving financial social assistance for different types of households have been changed accordingly as described under point 4.2.1 of the questionnaire.

Ministry of Education, Science and Sport

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

The Act amending the Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act adopted on 17 July 2015 (in force since 1 January 2016) introduced a change relating to the criteria for granting rights to receive a subsidy for school lunch. Namely, more pupils in basic schools (single structure of primary and lower-secondary compulsory education) are entitled to this subsidy. .

12.2 Future policy changes announced since 1 July 2016

Ministry of Finance:

With amendment to the Personal Income Tax (ZDoh-2) a new progressive tax rate of 34 % has been introduced. Formerly rate of 41 % has been reduced to 39 %. The highest rate of 50 %, which used to be a temporary measure, has been maintained. The measure is in place from January 1st 2017.

Tax schedule for the year 2017 is:

Taxable base (EUR)	Rate
up to 8,021.34	16%
8,021.34 to 20,400.00	EUR 1,238.41 + 27% over EUR 8,021.34
20,400.00 to 48,000.00	EUR 4,625.65 + 34% over EUR 20,400.00
48,000.00 to 70,907.20	EUR 14,009.6 + 39% over EUR 48,000.00
above 70,907.20	EUR 22,943.46 + 50% over EUR 70,907.20

Also threshold for general personal income tax allowance has been increased by 300 EUR, from 10,866.37 EUR to 11,166.37 EUR.

The part of salary paid on the basis of business performance is no longer calculated in tax base. Special arrangement allows that 70 % of the average monthly salary of the employees in Slovenia per individual employee can be excluded from the tax base.

In order to participate in new tax benefits for the business performance the following conditions have to be fulfilled:

the salary paid on the basis of business performance is paid out once in a calendar year to all beneficial employees at once, if all employees are entitled to payout of business performance and the right for payout as well as entitlement criteria are laid down in the employer's general instrument, on which employees are informed in advance, or if payout for the business performance is based on a collective agreement and according to the criteria agreed in this collective agreement or agreed to a manner or on the basis of this collective agreement. All employees of an employer are entitled to a part of salary for the business performance if the conditions for entitlement are determined with the employer's general instrument and uniform for all employees.

Exclusion for the benefits entitled to the salary paid on the basis of business performance is only applicable in the sense of personal income tax treatment. Employer's contributions for social security will be calculated on the basis of tax assessment and according to the regulations for individual contributions.

The ZDoh-2R also introduces a new type of income that is not regarded as bonus, "Education and training within promotion of health at the workplace according to the act regulating safety and health at work".

So far the non-regular or infrequent benefits are not regarded in the tax base of the employee if the value of all benefits in the month does not exceed some defined amount. According to the Amendments this amount has been increased by EUR 2 and now equals EUR 15.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

Novelties regarding the Income from Employment Relationship from Abroad, for Tax Residents of Slovenia maximal tax exempt amount for meal allowance have been increased by 80 %, i.e. from EUR 6.12 to EUR 11.

As an important measure for reducing administrative barriers, simplification of the tax collection process and the fulfillment of tax obligations for taxable persons were introduced, thereby achieving the consistency of the tax procedure legislation. With the effect from January 1st 2017, taxpayers may request the tax authorities to issue a unilateral, bilateral or multilateral advance pricing agreement (APA).

Ministry of Labour, Family, Social Affairs and Equal Opportunities:

In **December 2016 the Act amending the Social Protection Benefits Act** (*Zakon o spremembah in dopolnitvah Zakona socialno varstvenih prejemkih* (OJ) RS, 88/16) was adopted. The Act entered into force in December 2016 and has been implemented since February 2017. The aim of the Act is to improve the social situation of older people living below the poverty threshold by encouraging them to take up financial social assistance and supplementary allowance in case of need. From February 2017 a wider circle (not all) of the beneficiaries will no longer be entered annotation on their property (*zaznamba*) and also their heirs will not be required to repay the received aid after the death of the beneficiary. This will only apply to those beneficiaries who have been granted financial social assistance or supplementary allowance from the 1st February 2017 onwards and do not own an apartment or house (where they actually reside and had permanent residence) worth over EUR 120,000. Financial Social Assistance or Supplementary Allowance granted before 1st February 2017 are recuperated from the estate of a deceased beneficiary - Financial Social Assistance is not recuperated from the estate of a deceased beneficiary who had been receiving the assistance for 12 months or less, certain other benefits regarding the recuperation are also possible; Supplementary Allowance is recuperated only up to 2/3 of the received funds.

Further amendments to the **Social Protection Benefits Act** are envisaged by the end of 2017. Based on new estimates of the minimum costs of living a new amount of basic minimum income will be set as required by the Article 8 of the Act in force.

Ministry of Education, Science and Sport

The Act amending the Exercise of Rights to Public Funds Act adopted on December 31th 2016 introduced a change relating to subsidy for school lunch in compulsory basic school. The act is in force since February 1st 2017):

- students whose income per family member amounts to 36% net of the average earning in the Republic of Slovenia are entitled to the total price of one school lunch per day;

Additional reforms and development guidelines in preschool education for 2015:

In November 2015, the Government of the Republic of Slovenia and representative public sector trade unions adopted the Agreement on measures relating to labour costs and other measures in the public sector for 2016 Based on the agreement the Act Regulating Measures Relating to Salaries and Other Labour Costs for 2016 and other Fiscal Balance Measures in the Public Sector temporarily limits expenditures on salaries and other labour costs and lays down certain other measures in the public sector. The Amendments to the Exercise of Rights from Public Funds Act were adopted in November, eliminating parts of austerity measures put in place by the Fiscal Balance Act of 2012. The amounts of child benefit in the fifth and sixth income brackets increased as of January 1st 2016 by approximately 10 percent or to the level reached prior

to the implementation of austerity measures, for which an additional EUR 4 million will be provided in 2016 and 2017.

In order to make it easier for beginning teachers, child care workers and other professional workers to enter the educational system (from pre-school to higher vocational education and adult education), the Rules on the teaching certification examination were amended at the beginning of September 2015.

Candidates who gained relevant work experience by teaching within the framework of the accredited/state-approved education system could take teaching certification examinations prior to the entry into force of the amendment to the Rules. The amendment to the Rules extends the forms of gaining work experience, as teaching certification examination candidates may, to a certain extent, have accredited organised indirect educational activities carried out outside the accredited/state-approved education system and teaching practices made within the study programme.

In July 2015, the National Assembly adopted the Resolution on the National Programme on Nutrition and Physical Activity for Health 2015–2025. The national programme is a strategic and comprehensive framework whose objective is to improve eating habits and to increase physical activity among the Slovenian population from the earliest period of life to very old age. The programme defined concrete and measurable objectives and measures in a variety of priority areas. Some of them are associated with education, such as the provision of healthy diets in line with the guidelines and recommendations (organised meals in kindergartens and schools and student meals), physical activities in the education system, etc. The inter-ministerial working group will provide for the coordinated operation and the implementation of the national programme will be provided. Specific activities will be defined in periodic implementation plans, on the basis of which the operationalisation of measures will be achieved, along with their operators and the necessary financial resources.

ANNEX

DEFINITION OF SOCIAL SECURITY CONTRIBUTIONS AND PAYROLL TAXES.

The following text has been adapted from Annex A of the OECD *Revenue Statistics*.

Social security contributions to general government

Classified here are all compulsory payments that confer an entitlement to receive a (contingent) future social benefit. Such payments are usually earmarked to finance social benefits and are often paid to institutions of general government that provide such benefits. However, such earmarking is not part of the definition of social security contributions and is not required for a tax to be classified here. However, conferment of an entitlement is required for a tax to be classified under this heading. So, levies on income or payroll that are earmarked for social security funds but do not confer an entitlement to benefit are excluded from this heading and shown under personal income taxes or taxes on payroll and workforce. Taxes on other bases, such as goods and services, which are earmarked for social security benefits are not shown here [...] because they generally confer no entitlement to social security benefits.

Contributions for the following types of social security benefits would, *inter alia*, be included: unemployment insurance benefits and supplements, accident, injury and sickness benefits, old-age, disability and survivors' pensions, family allowances, reimbursements for medical and hospital expenses or provision of hospital or medical services. Contributions may be levied on both employees and employers.

Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government

Contributions to social insurance schemes which are not institutions of general government and to other types of insurance schemes, provident funds, pension funds, friendly societies or other saving schemes [are included here if they are compulsory or quasi compulsory (e.g., by virtue of agreement with professional and union organisations)]. Provident funds are arrangements under which the contributions of each employee and of the corresponding employer on his/her behalf are kept in a separate account earning interest and withdrawable under specific circumstances. Pension funds are separately organised schemes negotiated between employees and employers and carry provisions for different contributions and benefits, sometimes more directly tied to salary levels and length of service than under social security schemes.

Payroll taxes

This heading covers taxes paid by employers or employees either as a proportion of payroll or as a fixed amount per person, and which do not confer entitlement to social benefits. Examples of taxes classified here are the United Kingdom national insurance surcharge (introduced in 1977), the Swedish payroll tax (1969-1979), and the Austrian Contribution to the Family Burden Equalisation Fund and Community Tax.